

open technologies and organic R&D that it does by itself. So we absolutely are involved in the Linux space. SUSE is one of our partners, and we do a fair amount of work with it.

Q Are you also involved in the OpenStack project?

We do not spend a lot of time with OpenStack right now. It is something that we are evaluating, to see that if it is an appropriate technology for us to embrace. But right now, we are not doing anything much with OpenStack.

Q Do you think India's open source talent pool is adequate?

Of course, we do have very good open source professionals in India. We work with open source technologies and use a number of open source products as part of our solutions and technology offerings to our customers. In terms of getting enough open source technology professionals, I think India is an extremely good place for that. I think it is one of the reasons India team works on such programs, as availability of talent is one of the key considerations in deciding what the company wants to do in a particular facility.

Q Was the talent availability scenario the same when you launched the facility in India seven to eight years ago or has it changed over a period of time?

It has definitely changed a lot. We started with our Clearpath mainframe technology as our focus area, which is internal Unisys technology. So over a period of time, I think we have definitely moved very much on to open source technologies. The talent availability now has improved a lot with the increasing awareness about open source.

Q What kind of open source technologies do you work on in the Indian facility?

We use open source technologies related to the user interface for our product. We use open source in our secure private cloud offering. We do a fair amount of organic development around all those things. Generally speaking, there is a lot that we can find in the open source space and translate into things that are appropriate not only for commercial computing but business critical or mission critical business computing. We make our own modifications and enhancements on the available technologies to meet specific business needs. That's why we want to hire folks who are familiar with open source technologies.

Q Are your clients in India ready to accept solutions built around open source technologies? How easy or difficult is it for you to convince them that even if your offerings are based on open source technology, they are secure?

In general, the market has started accepting open source technologies. You can see that with the success of companies like SUSE, Red Hat and others. In our segment of the business, where we deal with business critical computing, there is a certain degree of healthy



L N V Samy, VP, Engineering, GTC, Unisys

scepticism about adopting any new technology, whether open source or proprietary. The technologies are rigorously tested and go through an adoption cycle. But I think, in recent years, I have not seen a push back against open source technologies. The market place is adopting rather than rejecting them. The market sees open source as an economically viable means to get freedom of choice, without compromising on scalability and security. So we try to bring them the best possible solution, which gives them flexibility and security along with being open source.

In India, it is a bit different. We currently do not have many clients here who use our open source technologies because these are very recent—developed only in the last few years when we invested heavily in open source technologies. I find no reason why India should not sooner or later get more comfortable with this global phenomenon.

Q Can you explain how open source tools and technologies add value to your development processes?

Open source technology helps us immensely because we do not need to invest on technologies that are already available. Courtesy the freely available open source technology, we have the freedom to add value in the areas we have specialised knowledge in, including security, performance, etc. And we aim to bring open source technologies to mission-critical systems and add value. We work on open source software and convert it into a solution for our customers. So open source solutions contribute in a big way